negotiations with some of the commanders formerly allied with Najibullah, the forces of Ahmad Shah Massoud entered Kabul. Other mujahideen forces also entered the city and claimed control of institutions and neighbourhoods. A number of units from Najibullah's government joined Massoud's forces. Fighting began almost immediately between Massoud's forces and Gulbuddin Hekmatyar's Hizb-e-Islami. Massoud's forces, together with Mirza Murad Rustam's umbrella group popularly known as Junbish-e-Milli, launched rockets and artillery at Hizb-e-Islami strongholds while Hekmatyar's forces mounted attacks on the airport and areas around the palace, killing hundreds of civilians.

Asthana said, 'Massoud was a true warrior but too shy to become a political leader. At one point he was reluctant to become the defence minister but we persuaded him to accept the position as we wanted someone who w[r]as on top of Afghan policy making.'

The Afghanistan Justice Project report, however, said Massoud's objective during the tenure of the Islamic State of Afghanistan headed by Burhanuddin Rabbani was to defeat the forces fighting against him. Besides Hekmatyar, his force had to also fight the Hizb-e-Wahdat and later, even Mirza's Junbish forces.

According to the report, during the first year of the tenure of the Islamic State of Afghanistan in 1992, 'His (Massoud's) principal foe was Hizb-e-Islami, whose rocket attacks killed thousands of civilians between 1992 and 1995, according to humanitarian agencies working in the city. However, Hekmatyar was not the only leader ordering such attacks: every major armed faction in Kabul had an arsenal of heavy weaponry that they used in battles that raged in the streets of Kabul